BiyeFlow

Founder Product Roadmap and Business Overview

A family-first wedding operations platform for Indian weddings - starting with Durgapur, built lean, free-first, and trust-first.

Working document for founder alignment, cofounder discussion, MVP planning, and startup vision.

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1. Executive Summary

BiyeFlow is not intended to be another wedding vendor marketplace, venue discovery portal, invitation maker, or generic checklist app. The strategic opportunity is to become the family-side wedding operations layer: the place where guest count, event attendance, caterer headcount, stay pressure, decor expectations, registry guidance, and handovers stay connected.

Core thesis: free wedding operations utility -> structured high-intent wedding needs -> user-requested help -> consent-based partner revenue -> anonymous local cost intelligence -> B2B workflow after proof.

The first market is Durgapur because the founder has local knowledge and access to early users through friends and family networks. The product should validate real behavior locally before attempting West Bengal or PAN India expansion.

Decision	Current conclusion
Family app	Free-first. Do not charge upfront. Direct family subscriptions are weak because weddings are mostly one-time events.
First MVP	Wedding Operations MVP: guest count, multi-day attendance, caterer board, room planner lite, decorator brief lite, Control Room, manual WhatsApp copy, local-first storage.
Revenue	Not paid spreadsheets. Test opt-in partner requests, assisted services where risk is visible, sponsorship, and cost intelligence later.
B2B	Do not assume early B2B revenue. Event managers/decorators already use calls, meetings, venue visits, and inventory. Build B2B only after proof.
Cost	Founder-led MVP can be launched with Rs 0 to Rs 35,000 one-time cost and Rs 0 to Rs 5,000 monthly running cost if kept local-first and backend-free.

2. Market Reality

Indian wedding decisions are emotional, family-driven, and heavily influenced by local planners, relatives, venues, caterers, decorators, and WhatsApp conversations. In Durgapur, many families rely on event planners who can execute weddings across a very wide budget range. BiyeFlow should not try to replace those planners.

The better local positioning is: a wedding clarity and control app for families working with planners, caterers, decorators, hotels, and relatives. The app should help the family remain informed without pretending that software can replace venue visits, negotiation, or family decision-making.

Reality	Product implication
Families can use Excel, diary, Google Sheets, and relatives.	Basic planning tools must be free and easy. Paid handover PDFs are not a core business.
Event planners handle many operational tasks.	BiyeFlow should provide family-side clarity, not planner replacement.
Users reject early payment prompts.	Delay monetization until users request help or detailed outputs.
3D can be useful but costly.	Treat 3D as an experiment and future differentiator, not MVP foundation.
Trust does not exist on day one.	Build utility trust first, then local proof, transparency, consent, and neutral recommendations.

3. Product Positioning

BiyeFlow - Fair Wedding Control Room
Plan clearly. Compare fairly. Avoid overpaying.

The first product should not be separate tabs stitched together. It should be a connected wedding operations spine. When a guest count changes, that change should affect event-wise headcount, caterer count, room pressure, and Control Room alerts.

What BiyeFlow is	What BiyeFlow is not
Family wedding operations control room.	Vendor marketplace.
Multi-day guest and headcount engine.	Venue discovery app.
Caterer, room, decor, and registry clarity tool.	Paid spreadsheet.
Free-first utility that earns trust.	App that charges users before value is proven.
Future source of local cost intelligence.	Unverified price authority on day one.

Long-term vision: Wedding Digital Twin + Fair Cost Intelligence + Family Control Room + Vendor-Ready Handover. This vision should be reached in phases, not built all at once.

4. Product Pillars

Pillar	What it means
Family Control Room	One view for pending work, risks, changes, missing decisions, and handover readiness.
Multi-Day Headcount Engine	Guest data flows into event attendance, food count, stay pressure, room planning, and alerts.
Execution Handover	Caterer, room, decorator, and family handovers are generated from the same source of truth.
Fair Cost And Trust	Help families ask better questions and understand hidden cost risk before money is locked.
Visual Planning	References -> moodboard -> guided decor brief -> 2D layout -> semi-3D later.
Private Wedding Buzz	Trivia, friend invite, leaderboard, and games later, after the serious operations spine works.

5. First MVP Scope

The first MVP should be called Wedding Operations MVP. It should run without login, backend, payment gateway, WhatsApp API, AI, or 3D. It should be installable as a PWA and work from a free hosting URL.

MVP module	Functionality
Wedding setup	Wedding profile, family sides, city, events, dates, expected guest count.
Event engine	Multi-day events, event order, timings, meal slots.
Guest master	Guest groups, headcount, side, city, stay need, transport need, tags, notes.
Attendance matrix	Guest/group attendance by event with event-wise totals and overrides.
Headcount engine	Single calculation source for event totals, meal totals, stay count, room pressure, and changed counts.
Caterer board	Meal count board, count sent status, change-after-sent alerts, WhatsApp-ready summary.

MVP module	Functionality
Room planner lite	Stay-needed view, room estimate, family clusters, elder/VIP flags, room handover.
Decorator brief lite	Theme, references, zones, must-have, avoid list, budget range, decorator handover.
Control Room	Readiness cards, missing information prompts, risk signals, handover status.

MVP exclusions: vendor discovery, venue discovery, public community, full 3D, paid WhatsApp automation, native apps, cloud sync, partner dashboard, and PAN India coverage.

6. Week-Wise MVP Plan

Week	Build focus	Exit criteria
0	Finalize scope, backlog, data model, stack, acceptance criteria.	Roadmap and architecture are ready for sprint execution.
1	App shell, navigation, local-first storage, design system, PWA foundation.	App opens on desktop/mobile and data persists locally.
2	Wedding setup and multi-day event engine.	User can configure a multi-day wedding and basic events feed Control Room.
3	Guest master.	User can add/edit guest groups and see total/stay counts.
4	Excel/CSV import-export.	Realistic guest list imports, errors are clear, export reopens.
5	Attendance matrix.	Event-wise counts update immediately and reliably.
6	Headcount engine and Control Room signals.	Modules read from one calculation service and show count risks.
7	Caterer board.	Meal counts, count sent status, and change-after-sent alert work.
8	Caterer handover.	Clear WhatsApp-ready handover can be generated.
9	Room planner lite.	Stay pressure and family grouping are visible.
10	Room handover and decorator brief lite.	Room and decor handovers are usable.
11	Decorator handover and Control Room polish.	Readiness cards show guest, caterer, room, and decor status.
12	Mobile PWA quick actions.	Quick updates and WhatsApp copy work on mobile.
13	Private test with real wedding data.	Core flow works with realistic Durgapur dataset.
14	MVP release candidate.	Ready for 3 to 5 private family pilots.

7. Full Product Roadmap

Phase	Timeline	Goal
0. Validation and data spine	2-3 weeks	Durgapur interviews, quote formats, cost taxonomy, data model.
1. Wedding Operations MVP	10-14 weeks	Guest, events, caterer, room, decor, Control Room, handovers.
2. Private beta	4-6 weeks	3 to 10 real wedding pilots, onboarding, import/export fixes, basic registry/budget.

Phase	Timeline	Goal
3. Fair cost and registry	8-12 weeks	Cost calculator, quote risk, hidden-cost checklist, Durgapur ranges, West Bengal registry guide.
4. Decor layout and 3D experiment	8-12 weeks	2D layout, stage/entry/dining zones, semi-3D stage/event preview only if useful.
5. Private wedding buzz	4-8 weeks	Friend invite, trivia, games, leaderboard, countdown, photo prompts.
6. B2B workflow after proof	3-6 months	Inventory-aware proposal workflow, scope/version tracking, multi-client dashboard later.
7. Venue digital twin pilot	After paid proof	One or two Durgapur venue models only if there is real willingness to pay.
8. West Bengal expansion	After Durgapur proof	Bengali templates, city ranges, deeper registry guidance, partner ecosystem.
9. PAN India foundation	12+ months after regional proof	Regional templates, state registry guides, multi-language, scalable sync, partner APIs.

8. Revenue Model

The product should not rely on direct family subscription. Weddings are usually one-time for a user, and many users will reject payment if the app asks too early. The monetization system should be designed around free utility, user-requested help, and opt-in partner transactions.

Revenue path	What to test	Why it may work
Opt-in partner requests	Hotel rooms, transport, registry help, printing/gifts, honeymoon/travel.	These are real transactions connected to wedding context.
Assisted services	Detailed quote review, final operations review, registry help, room/stay help.	Only works when visible risk exists; should not be assumed as mass revenue.
Local sponsorship	Durgapur cost guide, registry guide, planning templates.	Can support content if clearly disclosed.
Anonymous cost intelligence	Community-reported Durgapur cost index and quarterly category reports.	Useful later after enough trustworthy sample data exists.
B2B workflow	Planner/event manager tools after family usage proof.	Only if it saves time, protects scope, or supports inventory.

Do not sell raw leads. Use explicit, purpose-specific consent before any partner sharing. The valuable data is not IP address; it is wedding city, date, guest count, stay/transport need, registry need, budget range, and user-requested assistance.

9. Cost To Build And Maintain

Cost mode	Estimated cost	Notes
Founder-led private MVP	Rs 0 to Rs 35,000 one-time; Rs 0 to Rs 5,000/month	Free URL, local storage, no backend, no login, no AI, no 3D.
Optional field/research	Rs 5,000 to Rs 20,000/month	Local interviews, testing, travel, data cleanup.
Founder-led public MVP	Rs 25,000 to Rs 1.5 lakh/month	If adding more support, content, analytics, AI experiments, or research.
Founder-led with support/content/research	Rs 1 lakh to Rs 4 lakh/month	Support, content, researcher/data ops, local marketing, compliance.

Cost mode	Estimated cost	Notes
Small paid team	Rs 5 lakh to Rs 15 lakh+/month	Engineers, design, QA, support, content/research, sales/partnerships.

Domain is not required for the first private MVP. It becomes useful later for trust, SEO, partner discussions, and public launch. The first MVP can be tested through a free deployment URL.

10. Architecture And PWA Strategy

The architecture should allow new modules to be added without rewriting the core. Every module must feed the Control Room with status, risk, next action, or handover readiness.

Layer	Design decision
Frontend	Vite + React + TypeScript with a restrained component system.
Storage	Dexie/IndexedDB local-first storage for MVP.
PWA	Installable PWA with desktop-heavy planning and mobile quick actions.
Backend	None in private MVP. Cloudflare Workers/D1/R2 only after sync or accounts are needed.
Imports	Excel/CSV import and backup export are core because families already use spreadsheets.
Messaging	Manual WhatsApp copy first. No paid WhatsApp API in MVP.
3D	Three.js or template-based rendering later, only after layout data and willingness-to-pay proof.

Core services: calculateHeadcount, calculateEventAttendance, calculateMealCounts, calculateRoomPressure, detectGuestCountChanges, generateCatererHandover, generateRoomHandover, generateDecoratorHandover, calculateBudgetPressure, and generateControlRoomSignals.

11. Trust, Data, And Compliance

Trust is not owned on day one. It must be earned through utility, transparency, local proof, consent, and neutrality. BiyeFlow should never quietly sell personal data or hide partner incentives.

Trust layer	How to earn it
Utility trust	Guest, room, caterer, and decor tools work without payment.
Local proof	Friends and Durgapur families use it in real wedding planning.
Transparency	Cost ranges show sample size, city, date range, and confidence level.
Consent	Users decide when to request help and when data can be shared.
Neutrality	No hidden paid ranking, no silent data selling, sponsored items clearly marked.

When cloud accounts are introduced later, the product should support clear privacy notice, purpose-specific consent, data export, data deletion, and partner-sharing controls.

12. Validation Metrics

Category	Metrics
MVP usage	Wedding created, guest list imported, event counts configured, caterer count generated, room pressure checked, decor brief created, handover generated.

Category	Metrics
Retention	Day-7 revisit, day-30 revisit, repeat edits after initial setup.
Trust	Users say it reduced confusion, helped prepare a discussion, or helped avoid a mistake.
Intent	Hotel, transport, registry, gift/printing, travel, or detailed review request clicks.
Cost	Cost per active wedding, support minutes per wedding, infra/AI/storage cost if added.
Buzz later	Friend invites, trivia participation, leaderboard shares, guest-side repeat visit.

13. Key Risks And Counters

Risk	Counter
Becoming another checklist app	Every feature must connect to headcount, risk, handover, cost, or execution.
Users refuse to pay	Assume free core. Monetize via opt-in partner transactions, sponsorship, and visible-risk services.
B2B is overestimated	Build B2B only after structured family demand proves a specific paid workflow.
3D is expensive and uncertain	Start with 2D and semi-3D experiments. Do not build venue twins without paid proof.
Free users create cost	Local-first, no login, no backend, manual WhatsApp, no AI/3D in MVP.
Trust is weak initially	Start local, show methodology, disclose sponsors, and never silently sell data.

14. Cofounder Discussion Notes

A potential cofounder should understand that BiyeFlow is not a quick marketplace clone. It is a long-game trust and operations product. The early wedge is not revenue; it is real wedding usage, structured wedding intent, and local proof.

What a cofounder should align on	Meaning
Free-first discipline	Do not force early payment. Earn usage before monetization.
Local-first validation	Durgapur proof comes before West Bengal and PAN India ambition.
Technical restraint	Avoid backend, AI, 3D, and native apps until validated.
Data ethics	Use consent-based partner requests, not silent lead selling.
Agile execution	2-week sprints, real demos, real family testing, measurable learning.
Long-term ambition	Wedding operating system with fair-cost intelligence, visual planning, private buzz, and execution clarity.

Final direction: build a free, local-first Wedding Operations MVP that proves families will use BiyeFlow as their source of clarity before we spend heavily or monetize aggressively.